Families Reunite After Evacuation From Oleshky

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Residents evacuated from the Russian-occupied city of Oleshky have crossed into Ukrainian-held territory after a **humanitarian** mission and a localized **ceasefire**, Ukrainian officials said.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said the Ukrainian citizens from Oleshky had crossed in the Chernihiv region and that all of them will receive the assistance they need. He thanked the U.S. and Melania Trump for **mediation**.

The residents travelled by bus and plane through Russia and Belarus. Russia's Ministry of Defence said those travelling to Ukrainian-held territory were taken to the Russian city of Anapa and flown to the Belarusian city of Homel, accompanied by Dmytro Lubinets, Ukraine's commissioner for human rights.

Ukrainian authorities did not permit **disclosure** of the number of **evacuees** or the exact location of the border crossing. Ukrainian organizers said the restrictions were imposed in part to safeguard residents who chose to remain in Oleshky and to protect similar **humanitarian** missions that may occur.

The **ceasefire** in Ukraine's southern Kherson region began at 3 a.m. local time on Tuesday and is expected to continue through Sunday evening. Civilians from Oleshky, on the Dnipro River, began the journey in bus convoys on Friday. The estimated 2,000 remaining residents were offered the choice of travelling to Ukrainian- or Russian-held territory, or remaining in the city with replenished food and medical supplies, the article says.

On Saturday, relatives waited at the border between Ukraine and Belarus, along with aid tents, coffee stands and provisions to feed pets **evacuees** were bringing. Volunteers from organizations including the Red Cross, Doctors Without Borders and World Central Kitchen were also there.

Among those waiting was Liza Paliy, 19, who last saw her father more than two years ago. She, her mother and sister had left at the time, while he stayed behind, expecting, she said, to return within a month or two.

Word Treasure

humanitarian -- Concerned with helping people who are suffering or in danger.
ceasefire -- An agreement to stop fighting for a period of time.
mediation -- Help from a third party to bring sides together toward an agreement.
evacuees -- People who have been moved away from a dangerous place to safety.
disclosure -- Revealing or making information known to others.

Background you need

Oleshky is a city in Ukraine's southern Kherson region that is occupied by Russia, and its residents have been separated from family members in Ukrainian-held territory.

A humanitarian mission is an organised effort to help civilians, and a localized ceasefire can pause fighting in one area so people can travel safely.

For this journey, residents travelled by bus and plane through Russia and Belarus to reach Ukrainian-held territory.

Aid organisations and volunteers waited at the border with tents, food and provisions so families could reunite and receive help.

Break it down

LEAD: Residents evacuated from Russian-occupied Oleshky crossed into Ukrainian-held territory and reunited with families.

KEY EVENT: A humanitarian mission and a localized ceasefire made the journey possible.

+- THE JOURNEY: Residents travelled by bus and plane through Russia and Belarus

+- AT THE BORDER: Relatives waited with aid tents, coffee stands and volunteers from aid organisations

EVIDENCE: Ukrainian authorities limited disclosure of numbers and the exact crossing location to safeguard residents who stayed and to protect future missions.

OPEN QUESTION: The estimated 2,000 remaining residents could travel to either side or stay in Oleshky with replenished supplies.

Why it matters

The mission reunited families who had been separated for more than two years. It also shows how temporary ceasefires and mediation can create a safe path for civilians.

Test what you remember

1. **In which region did the evacuated residents cross into Ukrainian-held territory, according to President Zelenskyy?**
   - (A) The Chernihiv region
   - (B) Homel
   - (C) The Kherson region
   - (D) Anapa
2. **Who did Zelenskyy thank for mediation?**
   - (A) The U.S. and Melania Trump
   - (B) The Red Cross
   - (C) World Central Kitchen
   - (D) Doctors Without Borders
3. **How did the residents travel on their journey?**
   - (A) Only on foot
   - (B) By bus and plane through Russia and Belarus
   - (C) By boat down the Dnipro River
   - (D) By train through Ukraine
4. **When did the ceasefire in the Kherson region begin, and how long is it expected to continue?**
   - (A) At 3 a.m. local time on Tuesday, through Sunday evening
   - (B) On Saturday, until the border closed
   - (C) On Friday, for one day
   - (D) More than two years ago
5. **What choice were the estimated 2,000 remaining residents of Oleshky offered?**
   - (A) To fly to Anapa only
   - (B) To join the Red Cross
   - (C) Travelling to Ukrainian- or Russian-held territory, or remaining in the city with replenished food and medical supplies
   - (D) To disclose the crossing location
6. **Who was Liza Paliy waiting for at the border?**
   - (A) Her father, whom she last saw more than two years ago
   - (B) Her neighbours from Oleshky
   - (C) President Zelenskyy
   - (D) Dmytro Lubinets

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: B 4: A 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. President Volodymyr Zelenskyy: Zelenskyy said the citizens from Oleshky had crossed in the Chernihiv region, that all of them will receive the assistance they need, and he thanked the U.S. and Melania Trump for mediation.

2. Russia's Ministry of Defence: The ministry said those travelling to Ukrainian-held territory were taken to Anapa and flown to Homel, accompanied by Ukraine's commissioner for human rights.

3. Ukrainian organizers: Organizers said disclosure restrictions were imposed in part to safeguard residents who chose to remain in Oleshky and to protect similar humanitarian missions that may occur.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):